

ABOUT

New technology keeps showing up. I learn it, build something real with it, and spend the next few years explaining it to everyone else. CGI, REST, IoT, and now AI agents and MCP — same habit, thirty years running.

Five years as a crisis line operator informs how I think about product, language, and the difference between sounding helpful and being helpful.

SELECTED WORK

INNOVATOR

Trailhead — Salesforce

Built Medals in June 2014: a Node.js app with JSON/Markdown-authored challenges, baked-in gamification, and automated lesson checks. Sixty-six days later it shipped at Dreamforce 2014 as Project Trailhead. Salesforce calls me the Godfather of Trailhead.

CREATOR · PRODUCER · HOST

Salesforce Developer Podcast

Founded the show (2019–2023). Wrote the format. Sourced and researched every guest personally. Produced and hosted hundreds of episodes covering AI, Apex, integrations, and the people behind them. Built its audience on editorial mission, not brand.

PUBLIC SPEAKING

AI Advocacy & Technical Education

Keynotes and workshops on AI agents and MCP anchored in real philosophy (Bostrom, Foot, Laplace) and landed on concrete takeaways practitioners can use the same week. Recent keynote: *Behind the AI: From Theory to Practice and In Between* (Mile High Dreamin' 2025).

EXPERIENCE

2010 → Present

Salesforce

Chicago · Remote · 16 years

Senior Director, Admin Evangelist & AI Advocate May 2023 → present

AI advocacy for the Salesforce Admin community. Talks and workshops anchored in real philosophy (Bostrom, Foot, Laplace, Amber Case) and landed on concrete Agentforce takeaways: guardrails, edge-case prompting, data hygiene, enhance-not-replace. Conference content at Dreamforce and TDX. Written content at admin.salesforce.com.

Senior Director, Developer Evangelism Nov 2017 – Apr 2023

Developer Evangelism as Trailhead scaled. Conference content, code projects, written content. Launched the Salesforce Developer Podcast in late 2019.

Principal Developer Evangelist Nov 2014 – Nov 2017

Right after Trailhead launched. Conference content, code projects, written content, community-building as it grew.

Developer Evangelist Nov 2010 – Nov 2014

Conference talks, hackathons, code samples, ELEVATE Workshops across North America. Salesforce was shifting to REST-first APIs — a lot of the work was helping developers figure out what to build with that. Ran the IoT Zone in 2014 and 2015: demo stations and hands-on workshops. Built Medals in 2014 to solve a workshop problem; it became Project Trailhead sixty-six days later.

2007 → 2010

Model Metrics

Chicago, IL · Senior Developer

Client work for General Motors and NBC Universal. Lead developer on Expense2GO, a native iPhone expense app with Salesforce integration that

TOOLKIT

Communication & content

Podcast production Long-form writing
Public speaking Keynote design
Workshop design Editorial direction
Executive translation

Salesforce platform

Apex Lightning Web Components
Flow Metadata API SOQL SLDS
Salesforce CLI

AI & tooling

Agentforce Prompt engineering
LLM integration RAG
AI-native authoring AI adoption strategy

Languages

JavaScript / TypeScript Python Java
C# PHP HTML/CSS Perl

SPEAKING

Dreamforce · TDX ·
Agentforce World Tours · Forcelandia ·
Mile High Dreamin' · Midwest Dreamin' ·
Cactusforce · Snowforce ·
True North Dreamin' · Dreamin' In Data ·
DevOps Dreamin' (London)

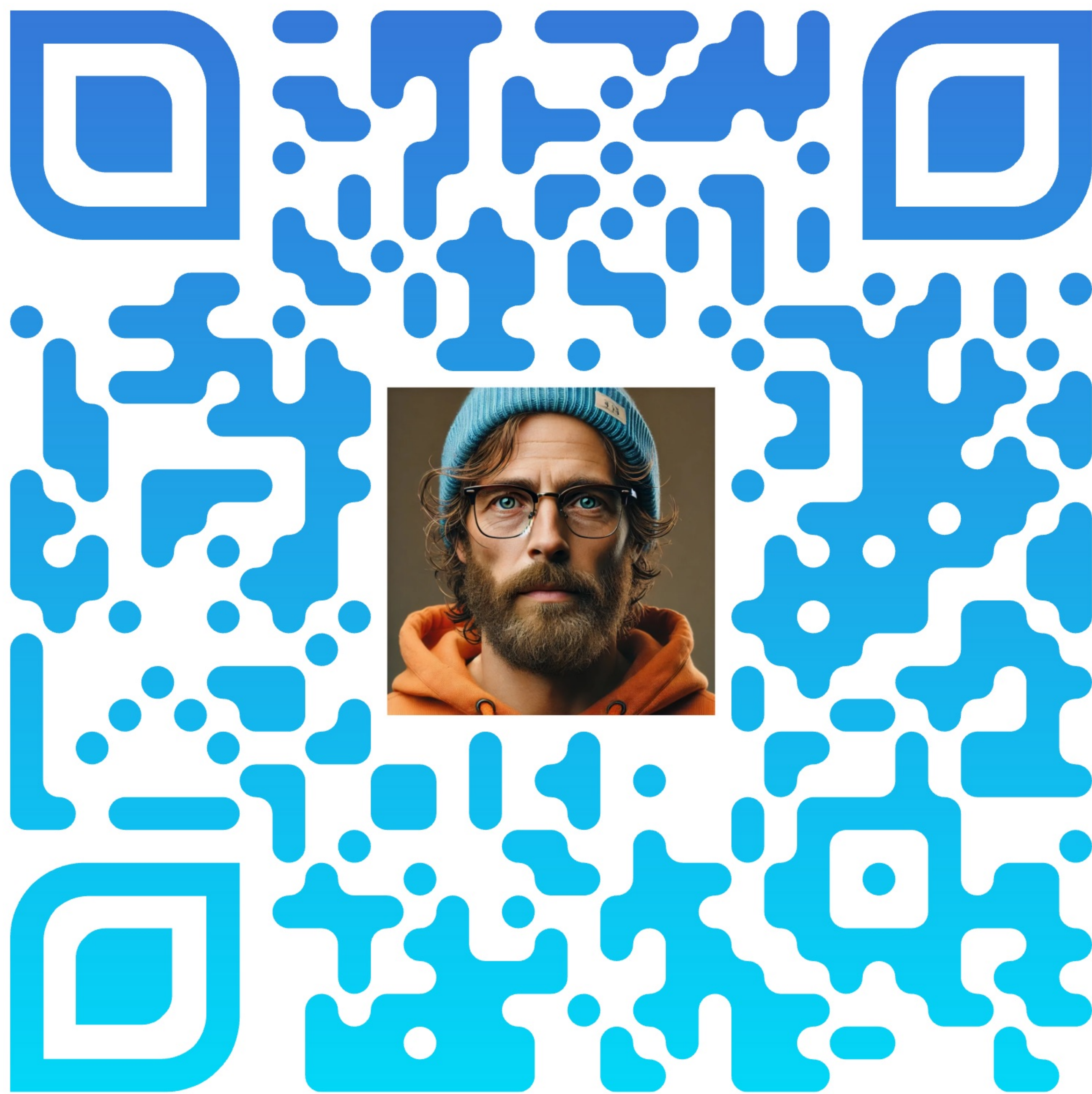
EDUCATION & SERVICE

Illinois Wesleyan University

B.A., Psychology & English · 1992–1996

Crisis Line Operator, PATH

Bloomington-Normal, IL · 5 years
Active intervention including suicide response.



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